

Principles of Communication or the 7 C's

The transmission of messages in communication should be based on the principles known as the principles of 7 c's. Each principle starts with the alphabet C, hence they are called the 7 c's.

Completeness

- ★ Provide all the necessary information.
- ★ Answer all the questions asked.
- ★ Some extra information should also be given, if deemed necessary.

Examples:

1. Please fax me in return the departure from Singapore to Hong Kong on the 8th.
(Some extra information like time, day, date, flight no., cost, departure time and arrival time should also be given).
2. How come my request for an interview letter did not receive a response?
(The answer to questions like when was the letter sent, who sent it, to whom the reply should be addressed are missing).
3. Show me a portable TV.
(The model, brand, price range and other details are missing).

Concreteness

- ★ Use specific facts and figures to put action to your words.
- ★ Avoid words like soon, later, few, quickly, at an early date, etc.
- ★ Use active voice and figurative language.
- ★ Use clear, image building words, logical statements instead of emotional statements.
- ★ Pinpoint facts, instead of vague statements.

Examples:

1. Goods will be delivered as soon as possible.
 - Goods will be sent by the 23rd of February, 2015.
2. Send me the consignment of a few shoes.
(Specify the size, color and other details).
3. This book is really good.
 - The book entitled Soups and Souls by Javed Jabber is really good.
4. The tests were administered by the professor.
 - The professor administered the tests.
5. Duties shall be assigned to the secretary.
 - The secretary shall do the duty.

6. It was decided by the Dean.
 - The Dean decided.
7. The company is in great danger.
 - The company is in danger because of the great economic crises.

Consideration

- ★ Adopt the 'you' attitude by giving importance to the customer or the client.
- ★ Emphasize the positive points by avoiding negative messages.

Examples:

1. I am delighted to announce that we will be extending shopping hours to make shopping more convenient.
 - You will be able to shop more conveniently with the extended hours.
2. We are glad to inform you that we have selected you as the Manager in our firm.
 - You have been selected as the Manager of our firm.
3. You have failed to enclose the cheque in the envelope.
 - Please enclose the cheque.
4. Your consignment was not delivered in time because you did not specify the size of the jackets.
 - Kindly specify the size of the jackets so that the consignment may be sent to you in time.

Conciseness/Compactness

- ★ Use the fewest possible words to communicate a complete message.
- ★ Avoid wordy/lengthy expressions.
- ★ Avoid irrelevant material and repetition.

Examples:

1. At this time ---- now
2. We are in need of ---- we need
3. Due to the fact ---- because
4. Please find attached the list you requested.
 - The list you request is attached.
5. She bought desks that are of the executive type.
 - She bought executive type of desks.
6. The literature which is enclosed will give you an idea of the appearance of this house.
 - The enclosed literature illustrates this house.
7. We visited their branch office, which is located in the city of Multan.

- We visited their branch office in Multan.
- 8. We have received your order, dated February 23, for which we thank you.
- Thank you for your order, dated February 23, 2015.

Courtesy

- ★ You should be sincere, thoughtful, and appreciative.
- ★ Show courtesy to your receiver.
- ★ Deal tactfully, show respect, avoid blunt expressions.
- ★ No gender discrimination. Avoid man words like manpower, man made, best man, chairman, where women are also working.
- ★ Know your audience.

Examples:

1. We do not accept spoiled and un-hygienic food. Please take it back.
 - We wish to return your consignment because we only accept fresh and hygienic food.
2. I wrote this letter three times. I don't know why you could not understand.
 - I am sorry that the point was not clear to you. Here is another version.

Clearness or clarity

- ★ Use simple language and familiar words.
- ★ Presence of coherence and unity in paragraphs.
- ★ Think wisely, but communicate in the language of the people.

Examples:

1. Being an excellent lawyer, I am sure you can help us.
 - As you are an excellent lawyer, you can surely help us.
2. His report was about managers, broken down by age and gender.
 - His report was about the age and gender of managers.
3. After planting 10.000 berry plants, the deer came into the botanist's farm and crushed them.
 - After our botanist had planted 10,000 berry plants, the deer came into the farm and crushed them.

Correctness

- ★ Use the right language with proper grammar, punctuation, spellings.
- ★ Accuracy of facts and figures must be checked.
- ★ Avoid words that confuse, use simple words instead.

MORE OF THE 7 C's

Credibility

It is not possible to have a reliable communication until and unless the sender is viewed as a credible source for doing business. In short, credibility builds trust.

Consistency

A consistent thought or approach is very important for the sender. Thoughts are formulated before speaking or sending a message and some start crystallizing while the message is being transmitted.